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THE PORTFOLIO JIGSAW, STOCK BY STOCK

There's an old riddle that serves as a nice logic test for children. Suppose you're on a long car trip, trying to prevent backseat warfare among three children, ages six, ten, and fourteen. This riddle offers the chance of preserving peace between Altoona and Pittsburgh.

Ask the three fidgeters the following question:

"Suppose we visit a coal mine. It's an underground mine, and two miners have come up the shaft in an elevator as we arrive. We see them get out of the elevator car and head for the locker room. One miner has a clean face, but the other miner has a dirty face. Which one will wash his face?"

The six-year-old doesn't hesitate: "Why, the one with the dirty face, silly. He has to wash it or his mommy will be mad at him when he gets home."

"Good," you reply. "Mommy taught you right. With such good manners, you can be a stockbroker when you grow up."

Then, about thirty seconds later, the ten-year-old shouts (ten-year-olds only shout), "No, I get it. The two men will look at each other. The man with the dirty face will see his friend is clean, so he'll figure his face is clean, too. But the miner with the clean face